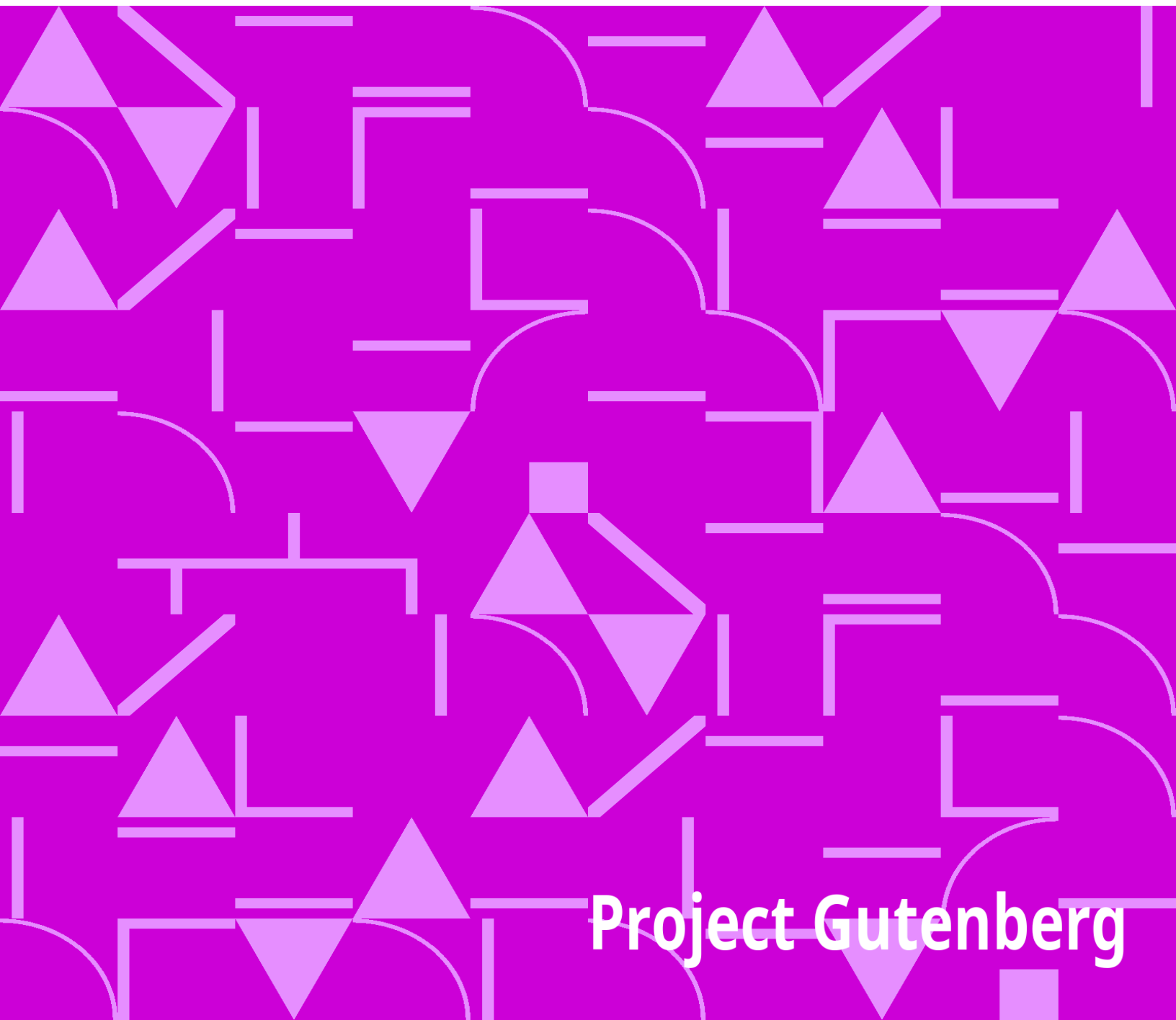


American Historical and Literary Curiosities, Part 21.

J. Jay Smith



Project Gutenberg

American Historical and Literary Curiosities, Part 21.

J. Jay Smith

Project Gutenberg

The Project Gutenberg eBook of American Historical and Literary Curiosities, Part 21.

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project Gutenberg License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

Title: American Historical and Literary Curiosities, Part 21.

Author: J. Jay Smith

Release date: July 16, 2004 [eBook #7921]

Most recently updated: December 30, 2020

Language: English

Other information and formats: www.gutenberg.org/ebooks/7921

Credits: Produced by David Widger. Scanning assistance from Geof Pawlicki
using Internet Archive Equipment

*** START OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AMERICAN
HISTORICAL AND LITERARY CURIOSITIES, PART 21. ***

**AMERICAN HISTORICAL
AND
LITERARY CURIOSITIES**

By John Jay Smith

Part 21.

Second Series

1860

AMERICAN
Historical and Literary Curiosities;
CONSISTING OF
Fac-Similes of some Plates, &c. Relating to
COLUMBUS,
AND
ORIGINAL DOCUMENTS of the REVOLUTION,
&c. &c.

WITH A VARIETY OF RELIQUES, ANTIQUITIES, AND AUTOGRAPHS.

EDITED AND ARRANGED,
WITH THE ASSISTANCE OF SEVERAL AUTOGRAPH COLLECTORS,

BY

JOHN JAY SMITH,
MEMBER OF THE HISTORICAL SOCIETY OF PENNSYLVANIA, ETC.

SECOND SERIES—COMPLETE IN ITSELF.

NEW YORK:
CHARLES B. RICHARDSON.
1860.

Enlarge

PREFACE.

THE First Series of "American Historical and Literary Curiosities," by John F. Watson, Esq. and myself, was commenced privately as a means of preserving many documents in the possession of our friends and ourselves; but they soon increased to such importance by contributions, that it was determined to publish them. Five editions were demanded by the public at home and abroad, and the work is now scarce and high-priced. The plates being worn out, no other edition of it is likely soon, if ever, to be issued.

This Second Series, complete in itself, owes its origin to the Commercial Panic, when it was desirable to employ several artists in want of work. It has been carried through by the assistance and contributions of various friends. I am particularly indebted to Ferdinand J. Dreer, Esq., Peter Force, Esq., Lewis J. Cist, Esq., Frank M. Etting, Esq., J. Wingate Thornton, Esq., Hon. George Folsom, Herman and Caleb Cope, Esqs., J. Francis Fisher, Esq., John Macalester, Esq., Charles J. Wister, Esq., Winthrop Sargent, Esq., Bushrod W. Adams, Esq. and others, and to the Philadelphia Library for the rare Broad-sides of the Revolution, and the Historical Society of Pennsylvania, whose valuable collections have been opened to my use in the handsomest and most liberal manner.

It may be proper to copy here a portion of the Preface to the fifth edition of the First Series, explanatory of the object of the work:—

"The past has a charm for Americans, as well as for the inhabitants of countries whose history extends far into the shadowy and unknown. *Our* early and romantic past has the merit of being known and truly related. Every thing which adds to these truths is sought for with avidity by the curious and intelligent inquirer. We have now many autograph-collectors, who may be viewed in the light of preservers of documents which would otherwise perish or be dispersed. To few, comparatively, are their treasures revealed. It was suggested, therefore, that some of the most rare 'Historical and Literary Curiosities' in the possession of individuals, should be grouped for the amusement and instruction of the present and of future generations, who may well know from printed accounts *what* things were done, but who can also thus learn *how* they were done."

As in the First Series, nearly all the articles in the present collection have been taken by competent artists from the originals of which they purport to be fac-similes. Considerable labor and trouble have been expended in collecting together and adapting the varied materials here presented, but I have been rewarded by the pleasure of the pursuit.

JOHN JAY SMITH.

* * Fully to understand the work, it is necessary, in turning over the pages, to have constant reference to the Tables of Contents, where will be found many explanations for which there was not space on the plates.

§§ 1

Original Volume 2, Part Ten

CONTENTS.—No. X.

PLATES LVIII. TO LXII.

PLATE LVIII.—1. Portrait of William Cobbett, from a rare full-length print. *In possession of John McAllister, Jr.*

2. Amusing Note, in rhyme and prose, from Cobbett to his paper-maker. *In possession of the same.*

PLATE LIX.—Photograph of six Swords, *in the collection of the Tennessee Historical Society, Nashville, Tennessee.* See the list on the side of the plate.

PLATE LX.—1. Handbill of the Committee of Safety, announcing General Howe's approach to Philadelphia. *In possession of Ferdinand J. Dreer.*

2. Handbill of Colonel Tilghman, aid-de-camp of General Washington; having brought official accounts of the surrender of Lord Cornwallis, &c., an ILLUMINATION is requested. *In possession of the same.*

PLATE LXI.—1. Highly-interesting Letter from Abraham Clark, of New Jersey, *written on the 4th of July, 1776.* Remarkable as showing the patriotic feelings of the moment. *In possession of the same.*

2. The whole of the letter in type.

PLATE LXII.—Interesting Notes from John Adams, and John Quincy Adams. *In possession of the same.*

In type. Address of Governor Isaac Shelby, of Kentucky, to the Militia, July 31, 1813. With the Autograph of the Governor, and of Colonel Robert Poage. *In possession of Lewis J. Cist.*

[Plate 58.](#)

[Plate 59.](#)

[Plate 60.](#)

[Plate 61.](#)

[Plate 62.](#)



William Cobbett.

Good Master Young,

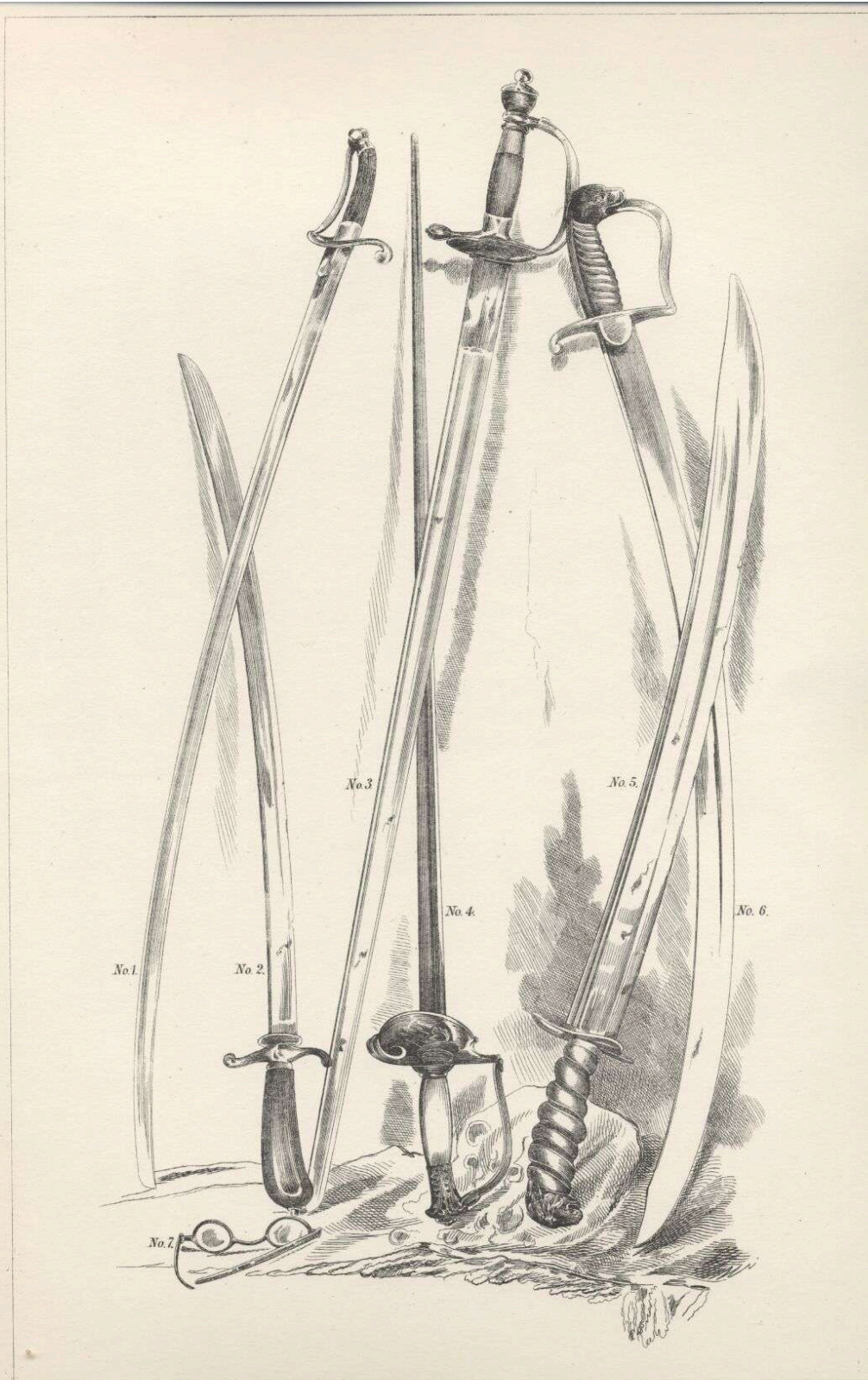
I cannot send the whole amount
With Christian pat'once watch and wait;
Take fifty dollars on account,
And give the bearer a receipt.

Wm Cobbett.

P.S. Though I know it is very difficult to rhyme
a presbyterian out of his money, yet when, in the
measure of Watts's psalms, rhyme ought to have
some weight. — I will discharge the rest of your
bill as soon as possible which, I hope, will be before
Saturday night.

Monday, 5. Feb. 1798

Enlarge



C. C. Hughes, Photographic Artist, Nashville Tenn.

Swords in the Collection of the Tennessee Historical Society, Nashville, Tenn.

No. 1. Sword of Col. Daniel C. Newman. No. 2. of Gen. Jeffers Sumner. No. 3. Taken from British officer at Battle of New Orleans. No. 4. of Col. John Sevier. No. 5. of Col. Du Puyser a British officer at the Battle of Kings Mountain 1780. No. 6. of Samuel Price of War of 1812, a Tennessean. No. 7. Spectacles of Gen. Nathl. Greene, of Revolutionary Memory.

Enlarge

IN COUNCIL OF SAFETY,

PHILADELPHIA, December 8, 1776.

Illumination.

S I R,

T H E R E is certain intelligence of General Howe's army being yesterday on its march from Brunswick to Princetown, which puts it beyond a doubt that he intends for this city.—This glorious opportunity of signalizing himself in defence of our country, and securing the Rights of America forever, will be seized by every man who has a spark of patriotic fire in his bosom. We entreat you to march the Militia under your command with all possible expedition to this city, and bring with you as many waggons as you can possibly procure, which you are hereby authorized to impress, if they cannot be had otherwise—Delay not a moment, it may be fatal and subject you and all you hold most dear to the ruffian hands of the enemy, whose cruelties are without distinction and unequalled.

By Order of the Council,

DAVID RITTENHOUSE, Vice-President.

To the COLONELS or COMMANDING
OFFICERS of the respective Battalions of
this STATE.

T W O O'CLOCK, P. M.

T H E Enemy are at Trenton, and all the City Militia are
marched to meet them.

COLONEL TILGHMAN, Aid
de Camp to his Excellency
General WASHINGTON, having
brought official accounts of the
SURRENDER of Lord Corn-
wallis, and the Garrisons of
York and Gloucester, those Citi-
zens who chuse to ILLUMI-
NATE on the GLORIOUS Oc-
CATION, will do it this evening
at Six, and extinguish their
lights at Nine o'clock.

Decorum and harmony are
earnestly recommended to eve-
ry Citizen, and a general dis-
countenance to the least ap-
pearance of riot.

October 24, 1781.

PLX

Enlarge

HIGHLY INTERESTING LETTER

(JULY 4, 1776)

FROM ABRAHAM CLARK, ONE OF THE SIGNERS OF THE DECLARATION
OF INDEPENDENCE.

PHILADELPHIA, July 4, 1776.

MY DEAR FRIEND :

Our seeming bad success in Canada, I dare say, gave you great uneasiness. In times of danger, and under misfortunes, true courage and magnanimity can only be ascertained. In the course of such a war we must expect some losses. We are told a panick seized the army. *If so, it hath not reached the Senate.* At the time our forces in Canada were retreating before a victorious army,—while Gen^l Howe, with a large armament, is advancing towards N. York,—our Congress resolved to declare the United Colonies *Free and Independent States.* A declaration for this purpose, I expect, will this day pass Congress. It is nearly gone through, after which it will be proclaimed with all the State and Solemnity circumstances will admit. It is gone so far, that we must now be a free independent State, or a conquered country.

I can readily guess at your feelings upon hearing that Gen^l Howe with 130 transports are between New York and the Hook. This was our last acct. No express hath come in this morning. All seems uncertainty where they will land. I assure you I don't feel quite reconciled at being here, and the enemy by my door at home.

All reports agree that New Jersey is all in motion to meet the enemy in case they pay our Province a visit, or to assist N. York, as occasion may require. Had Gen^l Howe landed his forces as soon as he arrived, he might have carried all before him. Possibly, while I am writing this, he may be reaping the fruits of a victory. This seems now to be a trying season; but that indulgent Father who hath hitherto preserved us, will, I trust, appear for our help and prevent our being crushed. If otherwise, his will be done.

I have no particular news more to communicate. No news from your family to send. I wrote you the day before I left home. I am among a consistory of things, as our enemy says. I assure you, sir, our Congress is an august assembly, and, can they support the Declaration now on the anvil, will be the greatest assembly on earth.

As I am not able to communicate to you any thing but what the public papers will announce, you will readily perceive I mean to let you know you are not forgot by me. Tho' I address myself to you, sir, yet I mean to include my much esteemed friend Mr. Caldwell in it.

We are now, sir, embarked upon a most tempestuous sea,—life very uncertain,—seeming dangers scattered thick around us,—plots against the military, and, it is whispered, against the Senate. Let us prepare for the worst. We can die here but once. May all our business, all our purposes, tend to fit us for that important event!

I am,

Dear Sir,

Yours and Mr. Caldwell's most obedient, humble servant,

ABRA. CLARK.

To Col. ELIAS DAYTON, N. J.

My Dear Friend,

Phil.^a July 4th 1776.

Our seeming bad success in Canada, I dare say gives you great uneasiness. In Times of danger, and under misfortune true courage and magnanimity can only be obtained. In the course of such a war we must expect some losses. We are told a Panick seized the Army - & so it hath not reached the Senate - At the time our Forces in Canada were retreating before a victorious Army, while Gen^l Howe with a large Armament is advancing towards N York, Our Congress Resolved to declare the United Colonies Free and independent States. a Declaration for this Purpose, I expect, will this day pass Congress, it is nearly gone through, after which it will be Proclaimed with all the State Solemnity circumstances will admit. It is gone so far that we must now be a Free independent State, or a Conquered Country.

I can readily guess at your feelings upon hearing that Gen^l Howe with 130 Transports are between N York & the Hook. This was our last Adv^{ce}. no express hath yet come in this morning - all being uncertainly where they will Land. I assure you I don't feel quite reconciled at being here and the Enemy by my Door at home.

* * * * *

We are now for embarked on a most tempestuous sea. Life very uncertain, seeming danger scattered thick around us. Plots against the Military, and it is whispered against the Senate, let us prepare for the worst. We can die here but not run away from our Business, all our purposes & pursuits tend to fit us for that important event. — I am Dear

Yours & W^m Caldwell's most Obedient S^{ts}

Thum^r Sir Abner Clark

Enlarge

Philadelphia May 24. 1791

inclosed my Dear son is a Post Note for
600 dollars which I pray you to receive
and send to your Mother. I am &c

John Adams
J. Q. Adams Esqr

Rev E Lockwood Esqr. Corresponding Secretary of the
Mercantile Library Association. New York

Quincy 29 Oct. 1841

Sir

On the day of my departure from Washington
for a short visit to my home, I caused to be inserted in the
National Intelligencer a notification of my inability to comply
with the numerous invitations which I had received, to
deliver Lectures or addresses before Literary or political
Associations among which was that received a very few
days before in your respected Letter of 12 September, and to
which an early answer was requested.

At the first moment of leisure that I have
been able to command, I feel it to be a duty, specially to express
to the Mercantile Library Association of New York, my regret
with which I am deprived of the pleasure which I should have
enjoyed in addressing them.

I am, very respectfully Sir your humble
and obed^t servant

J. Q. Adams.

Enlarge

FRANKFORT, July 31st, 1813.

DEAR SIR,

THE following address to the militia of Kentucky will inform you of the call that has been made upon the governor of Kentucky for a reinforcement to the North Western Army: and of my views as to the mode of complying with it. I forward one to you particularly, sir, under the hope that you will exert your influence to bring into the field all the men in your power. Be so good as to acknowledge the receipt of this letter, and apprise me of the calculations which I may make of the number of men that can be raised in your county—and whether it will suit your convenience to go with us. I shall at all times take a pleasure in acknowledging the public spirit by which you will be actuated—and the obligations you will lay me under.

I have the honor to be, very respectfully, sir, your obt. serv't.

Col. Rott Page.

Isaac Shelby

TO THE
MILITIA OF KENTUCKY.

FELLOW-SOLDIERS,

YOUR government has taken measures to act effectually against the enemy in Upper Canada. Gen. Harrison, under the authority of the President of the United States, has called upon me for a strong body of troops to assist in effecting the grand objects of the campaign. The enemy in hopes to find us unprepared, has again invested Fort Meigs; but he will again be mistaken; and before you can take the field he will be driven from that post.

To comply with the requisition of Gen. Harrison, a draft might be enforced; but believing as I do, that the ardor and patriotism of my countrymen has not abated, and that they have waited with impatience a fair opportunity of avenging the blood of their butchered friends, I have appointed the *31st day of August next, at Newport*, for a general rendezvous of KENTUCKY VOLUNTEERS. I will meet you there in person. I will lead you to the field of battle, and share with you the dangers and honors of the campaign. Our services will not be required more than sixty days after we reach head quarters.

I invite all officers, and others possessing influence, to come forward with what mounted men they can raise: each shall command the men he may bring into the field. The superior officers will be appointed by myself at the place of general rendezvous, or on our arrival at head quarters: and I shall take pleasure in acknowledging to my country the merits and public spirit of those who may be useful in collecting a force for the present emergency.

Those who have good rifles, and know how to use them will bring them along. Those who have not, will be furnished with muskets at Newport.

Fellow Citizens! Now is the time to act; and by one decisive blow, put an end to the contest in that quarter.

Frankfort, July 31st, 1813.

ISAAC SHELBY.

1+

Enlarge

*** END OF THE PROJECT GUTENBERG EBOOK AMERICAN
HISTORICAL AND LITERARY CURIOSITIES, PART 21. ***

Updated editions will replace the previous one—the old editions will be renamed.

Creating the works from print editions not protected by U.S. copyright law means that no one owns a United States copyright in these works, so the Foundation (and you!) can copy and distribute it in the United States without permission and without paying copyright royalties. Special rules, set forth in the General Terms of Use part of this license, apply to copying and distributing Project Gutenberg™ electronic works to protect the PROJECT GUTENBERG™ concept and trademark. Project Gutenberg is a registered trademark, and may not be used if you charge for an eBook, except by following the terms of the trademark license, including paying royalties for use of the Project Gutenberg trademark. If you do not charge anything for copies of this eBook, complying with the trademark license is very easy. You may use this eBook for nearly any purpose such as creation of derivative works, reports, performances and research. Project Gutenberg eBooks may be modified and printed and given away—you may do practically ANYTHING in the United States with eBooks not protected by U.S. copyright law. Redistribution is subject to the trademark license, especially commercial redistribution.

START: FULL LICENSE

THE FULL PROJECT GUTENBERG™ LICENSE

PLEASE READ THIS BEFORE YOU DISTRIBUTE OR USE THIS WORK

To protect the Project Gutenberg™ mission of promoting the free distribution of electronic works, by using or distributing this work (or any other work associated in any way with the phrase “Project Gutenberg”), you agree to comply with all the terms of the Full Project Gutenberg License available with this file or online at www.gutenberg.org/license.

Section 1. General Terms of Use and Redistributing Project Gutenberg electronic works

1.A. By reading or using any part of this Project Gutenberg electronic work, you indicate that you have read, understand, agree to and accept all the terms of this license and intellectual property (trademark/copyright) agreement. If you do not agree to abide by all the terms of this agreement, you must cease using and return or destroy all copies of Project Gutenberg electronic works in your possession. If you paid a fee for obtaining a copy of or access to a Project Gutenberg electronic work and you do not agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement, you may obtain a refund from the person or entity to whom you paid the fee as set forth in paragraph 1.E.8.

1.B. “Project Gutenberg” is a registered trademark. It may only be used on or associated in any way with an electronic work by people who agree to be bound by the terms of this agreement. There are a few things that you can do with most Project Gutenberg electronic works even without complying with the full terms of this agreement. See paragraph 1.C below. There are a lot of things you can do with Project Gutenberg electronic works if you follow the terms of this agreement and help preserve free future access to Project Gutenberg electronic works. See paragraph 1.E below.

1.C. The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation (“the Foundation” or PGLAF), owns a compilation copyright in the collection of Project Gutenberg electronic works. Nearly all the individual works in the collection are in the public domain in the United States. If an individual work is unprotected by copyright law in the United States and you are

located in the United States, we do not claim a right to prevent you from copying, distributing, performing, displaying or creating derivative works based on the work as long as all references to Project Gutenberg are removed. Of course, we hope that you will support the Project Gutenberg mission of promoting free access to electronic works by freely sharing Project Gutenberg works in compliance with the terms of this agreement for keeping the Project Gutenberg name associated with the work. You can easily comply with the terms of this agreement by keeping this work in the same format with its attached full Project Gutenberg License when you share it without charge with others.

1.D. The copyright laws of the place where you are located also govern what you can do with this work. Copyright laws in most countries are in a constant state of change. If you are outside the United States, check the laws of your country in addition to the terms of this agreement before downloading, copying, displaying, performing, distributing or creating derivative works based on this work or any other Project Gutenberg work. The Foundation makes no representations concerning the copyright status of any work in any country other than the United States.

1.E. Unless you have removed all references to Project Gutenberg:

1.E.1. The following sentence, with active links to, or other immediate access to, the full Project Gutenberg License must appear prominently whenever any copy of a Project Gutenberg work (any work on which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” appears, or with which the phrase “Project Gutenberg” is associated) is accessed, displayed, performed, viewed, copied or distributed:

This eBook is for the use of anyone anywhere in the United States and most other parts of the world at no cost and with almost no restrictions whatsoever. You may copy it, give it away or re-use it under the terms of the Project GutenbergTM License included with this eBook or online at www.gutenberg.org. If you are not located in the United States, you will have to check the laws of the country where you are located before using this eBook.

1.E.2. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is derived from texts not protected by U.S. copyright law (does not contain a notice indicating that it is posted with permission of the copyright holder), the work can be copied and distributed to anyone in the United States without paying any fees or charges. If you are redistributing or providing access to a work with the phrase “Project Gutenberg” associated with or appearing on the work, you must comply either with the requirements of paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 or obtain permission for the use of the work and the Project Gutenberg trademark as set forth in paragraphs 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.3. If an individual Project Gutenberg electronic work is posted with the permission of the copyright holder, your use and distribution must comply with both paragraphs 1.E.1 through 1.E.7 and any additional terms imposed by the copyright holder. Additional terms will be linked to the Project Gutenberg License for all works posted with the permission of the copyright holder found at the beginning of this work.

1.E.4. Do not unlink or detach or remove the full Project Gutenberg License terms from this work, or any files containing a part of this work or any other work associated with Project Gutenberg.

1.E.5. Do not copy, display, perform, distribute or redistribute this electronic work, or any part of this electronic work, without prominently displaying the sentence set forth in paragraph 1.E.1 with active links or immediate access to the full terms of the Project Gutenberg License.

1.E.6. You may convert to and distribute this work in any binary, compressed, marked up, nonproprietary or proprietary form, including any word processing or hypertext form. However, if you provide access to or distribute copies of a Project Gutenberg work in a format other than “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other format used in the official version posted on the official Project Gutenberg website (www.gutenberg.org), you must, at no additional cost, fee or expense to the user, provide a copy, a means of exporting a copy, or a means of obtaining a copy upon request, of the work in its original “Plain Vanilla ASCII” or other form. Any alternate format must include the full Project Gutenberg License as specified in paragraph 1.E.1.

1.E.7. Do not charge a fee for access to, viewing, displaying, performing, copying or distributing any Project Gutenberg works unless you comply with paragraph 1.E.8 or 1.E.9.

1.E.8. You may charge a reasonable fee for copies of or providing access to or distributing Project Gutenberg electronic works provided that:

- You pay a royalty fee of 20% of the gross profits you derive from the use of Project Gutenberg works calculated using the method you already use to calculate your applicable taxes. The fee is owed to the owner of the Project Gutenberg trademark, but he has agreed to donate royalties under this paragraph to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation. Royalty payments must be paid within 60 days following each date on which you prepare (or are legally required to prepare) your periodic tax returns. Royalty payments should be clearly marked as such and sent to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation at the address specified in Section 4, "Information about donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation."
- You provide a full refund of any money paid by a user who notifies you in writing (or by e-mail) within 30 days of receipt that s/he does not agree to the terms of the full Project Gutenberg™ License. You must require such a user to return or destroy all copies of the works possessed in a physical medium and discontinue all use of and all access to other copies of Project Gutenberg™ works.
- You provide, in accordance with paragraph 1.F.3, a full refund of any money paid for a work or a replacement copy, if a defect in the electronic work is discovered and reported to you within 90 days of receipt of the work.
- You comply with all other terms of this agreement for free distribution of Project Gutenberg™ works.

1.E.9. If you wish to charge a fee or distribute a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work or group of works on different terms than are set forth in this agreement, you must obtain permission in writing from the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the manager of the Project

Gutenberg™ trademark. Contact the Foundation as set forth in Section 3 below.

1.F.

1.F.1. Project Gutenberg volunteers and employees expend considerable effort to identify, do copyright research on, transcribe and proofread works not protected by U.S. copyright law in creating the Project Gutenberg™ collection. Despite these efforts, Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, and the medium on which they may be stored, may contain “Defects,” such as, but not limited to, incomplete, inaccurate or corrupt data, transcription errors, a copyright or other intellectual property infringement, a defective or damaged disk or other medium, a computer virus, or computer codes that damage or cannot be read by your equipment.

1.F.2. LIMITED WARRANTY, DISCLAIMER OF DAMAGES - Except for the “Right of Replacement or Refund” described in paragraph 1.F.3, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, the owner of the Project Gutenberg™ trademark, and any other party distributing a Project Gutenberg™ electronic work under this agreement, disclaim all liability to you for damages, costs and expenses, including legal fees. YOU AGREE THAT YOU HAVE NO REMEDIES FOR NEGLIGENCE, STRICT LIABILITY, BREACH OF WARRANTY OR BREACH OF CONTRACT EXCEPT THOSE PROVIDED IN PARAGRAPH 1.F.3. YOU AGREE THAT THE FOUNDATION, THE TRADEMARK OWNER, AND ANY DISTRIBUTOR UNDER THIS AGREEMENT WILL NOT BE LIABLE TO YOU FOR ACTUAL, DIRECT, INDIRECT, CONSEQUENTIAL, PUNITIVE OR INCIDENTAL DAMAGES EVEN IF YOU GIVE NOTICE OF THE POSSIBILITY OF SUCH DAMAGE.

1.F.3. LIMITED RIGHT OF REPLACEMENT OR REFUND - If you discover a defect in this electronic work within 90 days of receiving it, you can receive a refund of the money (if any) you paid for it by sending a written explanation to the person you received the work from. If you received the work on a physical medium, you must return the medium with your written explanation. The person or entity that provided you with the defective work may elect to provide a replacement copy in lieu of a refund. If you received the work electronically, the person or entity providing it to

you may choose to give you a second opportunity to receive the work electronically in lieu of a refund. If the second copy is also defective, you may demand a refund in writing without further opportunities to fix the problem.

1.F.4. Except for the limited right of replacement or refund set forth in paragraph 1.F.3, this work is provided to you 'AS-IS', WITH NO OTHER WARRANTIES OF ANY KIND, EXPRESS OR IMPLIED, INCLUDING BUT NOT LIMITED TO WARRANTIES OF MERCHANTABILITY OR FITNESS FOR ANY PURPOSE.

1.F.5. Some states do not allow disclaimers of certain implied warranties or the exclusion or limitation of certain types of damages. If any disclaimer or limitation set forth in this agreement violates the law of the state applicable to this agreement, the agreement shall be interpreted to make the maximum disclaimer or limitation permitted by the applicable state law. The invalidity or unenforceability of any provision of this agreement shall not void the remaining provisions.

1.F.6. INDEMNITY - You agree to indemnify and hold the Foundation, the trademark owner, any agent or employee of the Foundation, anyone providing copies of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works in accordance with this agreement, and any volunteers associated with the production, promotion and distribution of Project Gutenberg™ electronic works, harmless from all liability, costs and expenses, including legal fees, that arise directly or indirectly from any of the following which you do or cause to occur: (a) distribution of this or any Project Gutenberg work, (b) alteration, modification, or additions or deletions to any Project Gutenberg work, and (c) any Defect you cause.

Section 2. Information about the Mission of Project Gutenberg

Project Gutenberg is synonymous with the free distribution of electronic works in formats readable by the widest variety of computers including obsolete, old, middle-aged and new computers. It exists because of the

efforts of hundreds of volunteers and donations from people in all walks of life.

Volunteers and financial support to provide volunteers with the assistance they need are critical to reaching Project Gutenberg's goals and ensuring that the Project Gutenberg collection will remain freely available for generations to come. In 2001, the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation was created to provide a secure and permanent future for Project Gutenberg and future generations. To learn more about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation and how your efforts and donations can help, see Sections 3 and 4 and the Foundation information page at www.gutenberg.org.

Section 3. Information about the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

The Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation is a non-profit 501(c)(3) educational corporation organized under the laws of the state of Mississippi and granted tax exempt status by the Internal Revenue Service. The Foundation's EIN or federal tax identification number is 64-6221541. Contributions to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation are tax deductible to the full extent permitted by U.S. federal laws and your state's laws.

The Foundation's business office is located at 41 Watchung Plaza #516, Montclair NJ 07042, USA, +1 (862) 621-9288. Email contact links and up to date contact information can be found at the Foundation's website and official page at www.gutenberg.org/contact

Section 4. Information about Donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation

Project Gutenberg™ depends upon and cannot survive without widespread public support and donations to carry out its mission of increasing the number of public domain and licensed works that can be freely distributed in machine-readable form accessible by the widest array of equipment

including outdated equipment. Many small donations (\$1 to \$5,000) are particularly important to maintaining tax exempt status with the IRS.

The Foundation is committed to complying with the laws regulating charities and charitable donations in all 50 states of the United States. Compliance requirements are not uniform and it takes a considerable effort, much paperwork and many fees to meet and keep up with these requirements. We do not solicit donations in locations where we have not received written confirmation of compliance. To SEND DONATIONS or determine the status of compliance for any particular state visit www.gutenberg.org/donate.

While we cannot and do not solicit contributions from states where we have not met the solicitation requirements, we know of no prohibition against accepting unsolicited donations from donors in such states who approach us with offers to donate.

International donations are gratefully accepted, but we cannot make any statements concerning tax treatment of donations received from outside the United States. U.S. laws alone swamp our small staff.

Please check the Project Gutenberg web pages for current donation methods and addresses. Donations are accepted in a number of other ways including checks, online payments and credit card donations. To donate, please visit: www.gutenberg.org/donate.

Section 5. General Information About Project Gutenberg electronic works

Professor Michael S. Hart was the originator of the Project Gutenberg concept of a library of electronic works that could be freely shared with anyone. For forty years, he produced and distributed Project Gutenberg eBooks with only a loose network of volunteer support.

Project Gutenberg eBooks are often created from several printed editions, all of which are confirmed as not protected by copyright in the U.S. unless a

copyright notice is included. Thus, we do not necessarily keep eBooks in compliance with any particular paper edition.

Most people start at our website which has the main PG search facility:
www.gutenberg.org.

This website includes information about Project Gutenberg, including how to make donations to the Project Gutenberg Literary Archive Foundation, how to help produce our new eBooks, and how to subscribe to our email newsletter to hear about new eBooks.

AMERICAN
Historical and Literary Curiosities;
CONSISTING OF
Fac-Similes of some Plates, &c. Relating to
COLUMBUS,
AND
ORIGINAL DOCUMENTS of the REVOLUTION,
&c. &c.

WITH A VARIETY OF RELIQUES, ANTIQUITIES, AND AUTOGRAPHS.

EDITED AND ARRANGED,
WITH THE ASSISTANCE OF SEVERAL AUTOGRAPH COLLECTORS,

BY

JOHN JAY SMITH,
MEMBER OF THE HISTORICAL SOCIETY OF PENNSYLVANIA, ETC.

SECOND SERIES—COMPLETE IN ITSELF.

NEW YORK:
CHARLES B. RICHARDSON.
1860.

[back](#)

PREFACE.

THE First Series of "American Historical and Literary Curiosities," by John F. Watson, Esq. and myself, was commenced privately as a means of preserving many documents in the possession of our friends and ourselves; but they soon increased to such importance by contributions, that it was determined to publish them. Five editions were demanded by the public at home and abroad, and the work is now scarce and high-priced. The plates being worn out, no other edition of it is likely soon, if ever, to be issued.

This Second Series, complete in itself, owes its origin to the Commercial Panic, when it was desirable to employ several artists in want of work. It has been carried through by the assistance and contributions of various friends. I am particularly indebted to Ferdinand J. Dreer, Esq., Peter Force, Esq., Lewis J. Cist, Esq., Frank M. Etting, Esq., J. Wingate Thornton, Esq., Hon. George Folsom, Herman and Caleb Cope, Esqs., J. Francis Fisher, Esq., John Macalester, Esq., Charles J. Wister, Esq., Winthrop Sargent, Esq., Bushrod W. Adams, Esq. and others, and to the Philadelphia Library for the rare Broad-sides of the Revolution, and the Historical Society of Pennsylvania, whose valuable collections have been opened to my use in the handsomest and most liberal manner.

It may be proper to copy here a portion of the Preface to the fifth edition of the First Series, explanatory of the object of the work:—

"The past has a charm for Americans, as well as for the inhabitants of countries whose history extends far into the shadowy and unknown. *Our* early and romantic past has the merit of being known and truly related. Every thing which adds to these truths is sought for with avidity by the curious and intelligent inquirer. We have now many autograph-collectors, who may be viewed in the light of preservers of documents which would otherwise perish or be dispersed. To few, comparatively, are their treasures revealed. It was suggested, therefore, that some of the most rare 'Historical and Literary Curiosities' in the possession of individuals, should be grouped for the amusement and instruction of the present and of future generations, who may well know from printed accounts *what* things were done, but who can also thus learn *how* they were done."

As in the First Series, nearly all the articles in the present collection have been taken by competent artists from the originals of which they purport to be fac-similes. Considerable labor and trouble have been expended in collecting together and adapting the varied materials here presented, but I have been rewarded by the pleasure of the pursuit.

JOHN JAY SMITH.

* * Fully to understand the work, it is necessary, in turning over the pages, to have constant reference to the Tables of Contents, where will be found many explanations for which there was not space on the plates.



William Cobbett.

Good Master Young,

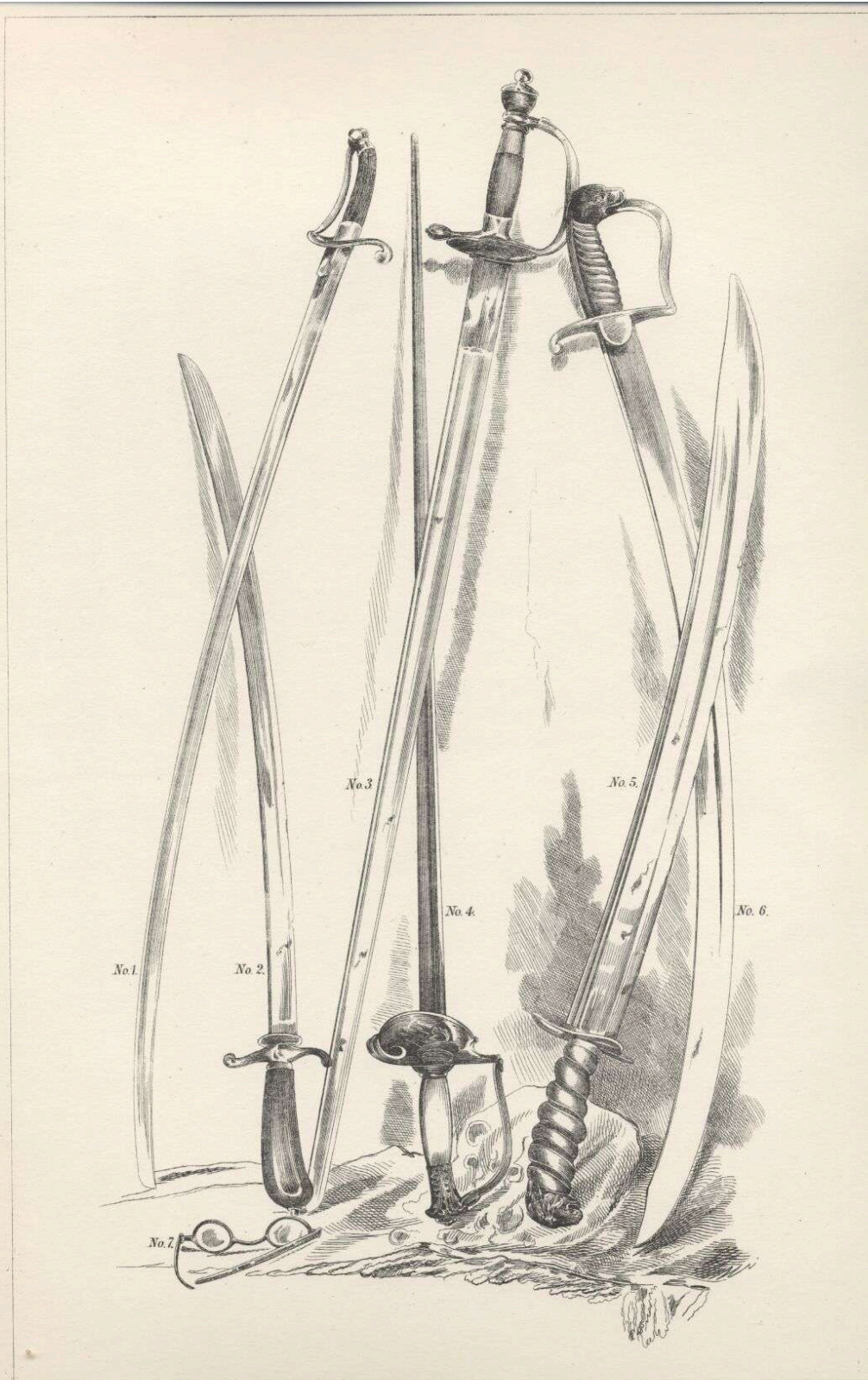
I cannot send the whole amount
With Christian pat'once watch and wait;
Take fifty dollars on account,
And give the bearer a receipt.

Wm Cobbett.

P.S. Though I know it is very difficult to rhyme
a presbyterian out of his money, yet when, in the
measure of Watts's psalms, rhyme ought to have
some weight. — I will discharge the rest of your
bill as soon as possible which, I hope, will be before
Saturday night.

Monday, 5. Feb. 1798

[back](#)



C. Hughes, Photographic Artist, Nashville Tenn.

Swords in the Collection of the Tennessee Historical Society, Nashville, Tenn.

No. 1. Sword of Col. Daniel C. Newman. No. 2. of Gen. Jeffers Sumner. No. 3. Taken from British officer at Battle of New Orleans. No. 4. of Col. John Sevier. No. 5. of Col. Du Puyster a British officer at the Battle of Kings Mountain 1780. No. 6. of Samuel Price of War of 1812, a Tennessean. No. 7. Spectacles of Gen. Nathl. Greene, of Revolutionary Memory.

[back](#)

IN COUNCIL OF SAFETY,

PHILADELPHIA, *December 8, 1776.*

Illumination.

S I R,

T H E R E is certain intelligence of General Howe's army being yesterday on its march from Brunswick to Princetown, which puts it beyond a doubt that he intends for this city.—This glorious opportunity of signalizing himself in defence of our country, and securing the Rights of America forever, will be seized by every man who has a spark of patriotic fire in his bosom. We entreat you to march the Militia under your command with all possible expedition to this city, and bring with you as many waggons as you can possibly procure, which you are hereby authorized to impress, if they cannot be had otherwise—Delay not a moment, it may be fatal and subject you and all you hold most dear to the ruffian hands of the enemy, whose cruelties are without distinction and unequalled.

By Order of the Council,

DAVID RITTENHOUSE, Vice-President.

*To the COLONELS or COMMANDING
OFFICERS of the respective Battalions of
this STATE.*

T W O O ' C L O C K , P . M .

T H E Enemy are at Trenton, and all the City Militia are marched to meet them.

C O L O N E L T I L G H M A N , Aid de Camp to his Excellency General WASHINGTON, having brought official accounts of the SURRENDER of Lord Cornwallis, and the Garrisons of York and Gloucester, those Citizens who chuse to ILLUMINATE on the GLORIOUS OCCASION, will do it this evening at Six, and extinguish their lights at Nine o'clock.

Decorum and harmony are earnestly recommended to every Citizen, and a general discountenance to the least appearance of riot.

October 24, 1781.

PLX

[back](#)

My Dear Friend,

Phil^a July 4th 1776.

Our seeming bad success in Canada, I dare say gives you great uneasiness. In Times of danger, and under misfortune true Courage and Magnanimity can only be obtained. In the Course of such a War we must expect some Losses. We are told a Party seized the Army - & so it hath not reached the Senate. At the Time our Forces in Canada were retreating before a victorious Army, while Gen^l Howe with a large Armament is advancing towards N York, Our Congress Resolved to declare the United Colonies Free and independent States. a Declaration for this Purpose, I expect, will this day pass Congress, it is nearly gone through, after which it will be Proclaimed with all the State Solemnity Circumstances will admit. It is gone so far that we must now be a Free independent State, or a Conquered Country.

I can readily guess at your feelings upon hearing that Gen^l Howe with 130 Transports are between N York & the Hook. This was our last Adv^{ce}. no express hath yet come in this morning. All being uncertainly where they will Land, I assure you I don't feel quite reconciled at being here and the Enemy by my Door at home.

* * * * *

We are now for embarked on a most tempestuous Sea. Life very uncertain, seeming danger scattered thick around us. Plots against the Military, and it is whispered. Against the Senate, let us prepare for the worst. We can die here but not run away from our Business, all our purposes & pursuits tend to fit us for that important event. I am Dear

Yours & Wth Caldwell's most Obedient S^{rv}Thumth Sir Abner Clark

[back](#)

Philadelphia May 24. 1791

inclosed my Dear son is a Post Note for
600 dollars which I pray you to receive
and send to your Mother. I am &c

John Adams
J. D. Adams Esqr

R. E. Lockwood Esqr. Corresponding Secretary of the
Mercantile Library Association. New York

Quincy 29 Oct. 1841

Sir

On the day of my departure from Washington
for a short visit to my home, I caused to be inserted in the
National Intelligencer a notification of my inability to comply
with the numerous invitations which I had received, to
deliver Lectures or addresses before Literary or political
Associations among which was that received a very few
days before in your respected Letter of 12 September, and to
which an early answer was requested.

At the first moment of leisure that I have
been able to command, I feel it to be a duty, & peculiarly to express
to the Mercantile Library Association of New York my regret
with which I am deprived of the pleasure which I should have
enjoyed in addressing them.

I am, very respectfully Sir your humble
and obed^t Servant

J. D. Adams.

[back](#)

FRANKFORT, July 31st, 1813.

DEAR SIR,

THE following address to the militia of Kentucky will inform you of the call that has been made upon the governor of Kentucky for a reinforcement to the North Western Army: and of my views as to the mode of complying with it. I forward one to you particularly, sir, under the hope that you will exert your influence to bring into the field all the men in your power. Be so good as to acknowledge the receipt of this letter, and apprise me of the calculations which I may make of the number of men that can be raised in your county—and whether it will suit your convenience to go with us. I shall at all times take a pleasure in acknowledging the public spirit by which you will be actuated—and the obligations you will lay me under.

I have the honor to be, very respectfully, sir, your obt. serv't.

Col. Rott Page.

Isaac Shelby

TO THE
MILITIA OF KENTUCKY.

FELLOW-SOLDIERS,

YOUR government has taken measures to act effectually against the enemy in Upper Canada. Gen. Harrison, under the authority of the President of the United States, has called upon me for a strong body of troops to assist in effecting the grand objects of the campaign. The enemy in hopes to find us unprepared, has again invested Fort Meigs; but he will again be mistaken; and before you can take the field he will be driven from that post.

To comply with the requisition of Gen. Harrison, a draft might be enforced; but believing as I do, that the ardor and patriotism of my countrymen has not abated, and that they have waited with impatience a fair opportunity of avenging the blood of their butchered friends, I have appointed the *31st day of August next, at Newport*, for a general rendezvous of KENTUCKY VOLUNTEERS. I will meet you there in person. I will lead you to the field of battle, and share with you the dangers and honors of the campaign. Our services will not be required more than sixty days after we reach head quarters.

I invite all officers, and others possessing influence, to come forward with what mounted men they can raise: each shall command the men he may bring into the field. The superior officers will be appointed by myself at the place of general rendezvous, or on our arrival at head quarters: and I shall take pleasure in acknowledging to my country the merits and public spirit of those who may be useful in collecting a force for the present emergency.

Those who have good rifles, and know how to use them will bring them along. Those who have not, will be furnished with muskets at Newport.

Fellow Citizens! Now is the time to act; and by one decisive blow, put an end to the contest in that quarter.

Frankfort, July 31st, 1813.

ISAAC SHELBY.